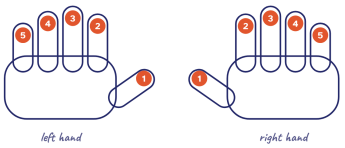
PLAYING AND LISTENING · FINGERING · LEARN



Fingering

REMEMBER Thumbs are 1 in both hands, little fingers 5.

1 Finger numbers ★☆☆

Write the number. The first is done.

FINGER	NUMBER
thumb	1
index finger	
middle finger	
ring finger	
little finger	

2 Five-finger position ★☆☆

Right-hand thumb on C, left-hand little finger on C: write the finger for each note. The first is done.

	C	D	E	F	G
right hand	1				
left hand					

3 C major, right hand ★★☆

Write the fingering going up. The first three are done.

	C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C
finger	1	2	3					

4 Play it ★☆☆

Play C D E F G up and down with each hand, saying the finger numbers. Tick a circle each day.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · FINGERING · USE

Fingering

REMEMBER Going up the right hand, the thumb passes under; coming down, finger 3 crosses over.

1 Under or over?

★★☆

Circle what happens. The first is done.

right hand going up, after finger 3	**thumb under** · **finger over**
right hand coming down, after the thumb	**thumb under** · **finger over**
left hand going up, after the thumb	**thumb under** · **finger over**
left hand coming down, after finger 3	**thumb under** · **finger over**

2 C major, left hand

★★☆

Write the fingering going up. The first is done.

	C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C
finger	5							

3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

The thumb is 1 only in the right hand.	T F
Write your fingering in once and keep it.	T F
The thumb should land heavily as it passes under.	T F

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play the C major scale, one octave, each hand alone. Tick a circle each clean day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 Explain it

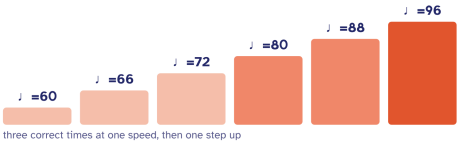
★★☆

Explain why it helps to write your fingering in and keep it.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PRACTISING WELL · LEARN

Practising well



REMEMBER Slow, small and correct; three correct times, then one notch faster.

1 The metronome ladder ★☆☆

The Handbook's ladder (p. 161) goes 60 66 72 80 88 96. Write the two missing steps. The first is done.

60 66 72 **80** ☐

2 Good habit? ★☆☆

Circle helps or wastes time. The first is done.

the hardest bar first	**helps** · wastes time
always from the top	helps · wastes time
faster to fix a slip	helps · wastes time
three correct, then faster	helps · wastes time
hands separately first	helps · wastes time

3 My fifteen minutes ★★☆

Plan your practice: what will you do in each part?

TIME	WHAT
2 min · warm up	
5 min · hardest bars	
5 min · join them	
3 min · play it through	

4 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Small chunks are easier to fix.	T F
Practise only what you can already play.	T F
Hands separately first, then together.	T F

5 Play it ★☆☆

Choose one hard bar and climb the metronome ladder. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PRACTISING WELL · USE

Practising well

REMEMBER Write it down: what got better, and what to start with tomorrow.

1 Practice log ★★☆

Fill in a line after each practice.

DAY	GOT BETTER	START WITH TOMORROW

2 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Playing fast and wrong teaches the wrong notes.	T	F
One long practice beats several short ones.	T	F
Count aloud to keep the rhythm honest.	T	F

3 Chunk it ★★☆

Choose a piece. Write the bars you will practise first, the hardest first.

Bars ☐ to ☐ , then ☐ to ☐

4 Play it ★☆☆

Practise for fifteen minutes with your plan from page 3. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 Explain it ★★☆

Explain why slow and correct is faster than fast and wrong.

Date _____
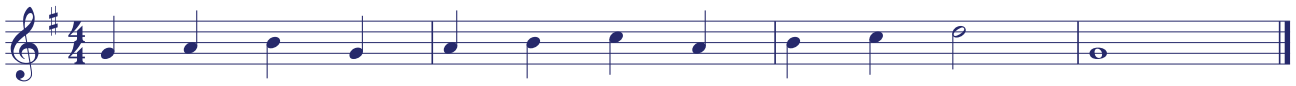
PLAYING AND LISTENING · SIGHT-READING · LEARN

Sight-reading

REMEMBER Thirty seconds of looking, then keep the beat going whatever happens.

1 Scan this ★★☆

Look at the music for thirty seconds and complete the sentences. The first is done.



Key: [G] major. Time: [ ] beats in a bar.

First note: [ ] . Bar 2 is bar 1 one step [ ] .

2 Scan order ★☆☆

Number the checks in the order of the scan. The first is done.

CHECK	ORDER
key	1
time	[ ]
first notes	[ ]
rhythm	[ ]
patterns	[ ]
marks	[ ]

3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Stop and fix every wrong note.	T F
Choose a speed you can keep.	T F
Read shapes, not single notes.	T F

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · SIGHT-READING · USE
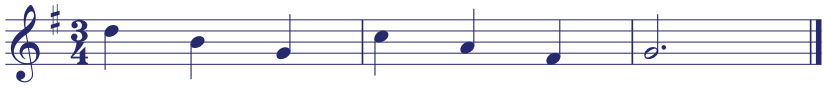
Sight-reading

REMEMBER Look one bar ahead while you play.

1 Scan this too

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.



Key: [G] major. Time: [ ] beats in a bar.

The F in bar 2 is played as [ ] .

2 Sight-reading log

★★☆

One new piece each day: scan, play once without stopping, then tick.

PIECE	SCANNED	NO STOPS
	☐	☐
	☐	☐
	☐	☐
	☐	☐
	☐	☐

3 Read ahead

★☆☆

Cover each bar with a card as you play it. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

A stop is heard more than a wrong note.	T F
Look down at your hands while sight-reading.	T F
Tap the trickiest rhythm before you start.	T F

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · LISTENING · LEARN

Listening



REMEMBER Major sounds bright, minor darker: only the middle note of the chord moves.

1 Intervals by song ★☆☆

Write a song that has each interval near its start. The first is done.

INTERVAL	SONG
perfect 5th	**Twinkle (2nd to 3rd note)**
major 2nd	
major 3rd	
perfect 4th	
octave	

2 Finished or not? ★★☆

In C major: does the ending sound finished? The first is done.

G → C	**finished** · **not finished**
C → G	**finished** · **not finished**
F → C	**finished** · **not finished**
Dm → G	**finished** · **not finished**

3 Bright or dark? ★☆☆

Play each chord and circle what you hear. The first is done.

C E G	**bright** · **dark**
C E♭ G	**bright** · **dark**
A C E	**bright** · **dark**
G B D	**bright** · **dark**

4 Play it ★☆☆

Play C E G and C E♭ G one after the other, then sing the middle note of each. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · LISTENING · USE

Listening

REMEMBER If you can sing it back, you can play it.

1 Clap it back

★☆☆

A friend claps two bars; you clap them back. Tick each one you get right first time.

rhythm 1 ○ **rhythm 2** ○

rhythm 3 ○ **rhythm 4** ○

2 How many beats?

★★☆

Listen to four pieces. Clap along and write the beats in a bar.

PIECE	BEATS
	☐
	☐
	☐
	☐

3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Major and minor chords differ by the middle note.	T F
A perfect cadence sounds unfinished.	T F
Close your eyes to listen better.	T F

4 Sing it back

★☆☆

A friend plays five notes; you sing them, then find them on the keys. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 Explain it

★★☆

Explain how you can hear whether a chord is major or minor.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PERFORMING · LEARN

Performing



REMEMBER Breathe, feel a bar of the beat, then begin. After a slip, catch the next beat.

1 The routine

Number the steps in order. The first is done.

STEP	ORDER
adjust the bench	1
breathe out slowly	
feel one bar of the beat	
play the first note	
stand and bow	

2 After a slip

Circle helps or does not help. The first is done.

keep the beat going	helps · does not help
go back and fix it	helps · does not help
rejoin at the next phrase	helps · does not help
stop and say sorry	helps · does not help

3 True or false?

Circle T or F.

Nerves mean you care.	T F
Practise starting from three places.	T F
The audience wants you to fail.	T F

4 Play it

A one-minute concert: walk to the piano, sit, breathe, feel a bar, play eight bars, bow. Tick a circle each day.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PERFORMING · USE

Performing

REMEMBER Play it once a day without stopping, as if someone were listening.

1 My concert plan

★★☆

Write your piece and three places you can start from.

piece	
start 1 (bar)	
start 2 (bar)	
start 3 (bar)	

2 Run-throughs

★☆☆

Play it through once a day without stopping. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 After the concert

★★☆

Write one thing that went well and one thing to practise next.

Went well

Practise next

4 Explain it

★★☆

Explain what you will do if you slip in the middle of your piece.

Date

PLAYING AND LISTENING · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 13.

1 Name it

★☆☆

Write the answer.

the finger number of the thumb	
the finger for G, right hand, thumb on C	
the step after ♩ = 72 on the ladder	
a song that starts with a perfect 4th	

2 Complete it

★★☆

One word in each space.

Practise the ____ bar first.

Before sight-reading, look at the key and the ____ signature.

After a slip, keep the ____ going.

3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Going up, the right thumb passes under.	T F
Minor chords usually sound brighter than major.	T F
Speed up only after three correct times.	T F

Score ____ / 10

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
finger numbers	☐	☐	☐	p. 159
scale fingering	☐	☐	☐	p. 159
a practice plan	☐	☐	☐	p. 161
the metronome ladder	☐	☐	☐	p. 161
the thirty-second scan	☐	☐	☐	p. 163
intervals by song	☐	☐	☐	p. 165
major or minor by ear	☐	☐	☐	p. 165
a performance routine	☐	☐	☐	p. 167

Teacher's note

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Numbers: 2, 3, 4, 5. Five-finger: right 1 2 3 4 5 · left 5 4 3 2 1. C major up: 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 5.
p. 2	Under or over: thumb under, finger over, finger over, thumb under. Left hand up: 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1. T/F: F, T, F.
p. 3	Ladder: 80, 88. Habits: helps, wastes time, wastes time, helps, helps. T/F: T, F, T.
p. 4	T/F: T, F, T.
p. 5	Scan: G major, 4 beats; G; up. Order: key 1, time 2, first notes 3, rhythm 4, patterns 5, marks 6. T/F: F, T, T.
p. 6	Scan: G major, 3 beats; F♯. T/F: T, F, T.
p. 7	Songs (or any that fit): Frère Jacques · Oh When the Saints · Amazing Grace · Somewhere over the Rainbow. Endings: finished, not finished, finished, not finished. Bright/dark: bright, dark, dark, bright.
p. 8	T/F: T, F, T.
p. 9	Routine: breathe 2, beat 3, first note 4, bow 5. After a slip: helps, does not help, helps, does not help. T/F: T, T, F.
p. 11	1 · 5 · 80 · Amazing Grace. hardest; time; beat. T, F, T.

“Play it”, “in your music”, listening and playing have no single answer to copy: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____